Day 37 - Whitetail Refuge, Hockley Heights

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Caledon Hills section · hike 46 · Mono Centre & Mono Cliffs Provincial Park

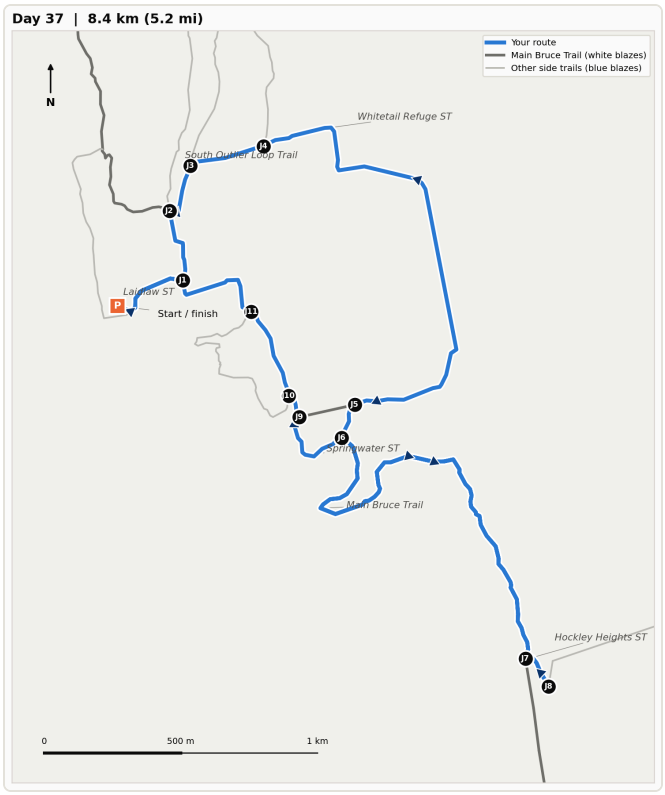
8.4 km / 5.2 mi	~2.3 h	2.0 km new	69 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park: Mono Community Centre, 200 m south of Mono Centre (County Road 8). Park in gravel lot. Google Maps.

Navigate: import *day37_hike046.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Whitetail Refuge Side Trail (1.8 km); Hockley Heights Side Trail (0.2 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** the gravel lot at the Mono Community Centre, about 200 m south of Mono Centre on County Road 8. The park's own lot on 3rd Line is pay parking; you won't need it today.
- **Main Bruce Trail through Mono Cliffs Provincial Park:** about 6 km of the Trail runs through the park, among rocky escarpment cliffs, cedars and ferns. Mostly gentle, with a few steep pitches. The park asks hikers to stay on trails; climbing and scrambling are not allowed.
- **South Outlier Loop Trail:** the park's yellow-marked trail, which the Bruce Trail shares in part. It's named for one of the park's two large outliers, chunks of escarpment separated from the main cliff edge.
- **Road walking:** short stretches of the main Trail and the Whitetail Refuge Side Trail follow road shoulders. Keep the dog close.
- **Whitetail Refuge, Springwater and Laidlaw side trails:** no published descriptions were found. The short Hockley Heights spur (0.2 km) is an out-and-back.
- **Dogs:** allowed on leash in the park. Check yourself and the dog for ticks afterwards.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Mono Community Centre, 200 m south of Mono Centre (County Road 8). Walk about 50 m to the trail. Head north on the blue-blazed Laidlaw Side Trail.
0.3	0.2	J1: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
0.4	0.3	Heads-up: The next 0.0 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.6	0.4	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed South Outlier Loop Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left; the blue-blazed Walter Tovell Side Trail goes off ahead.)
0.8	0.5	J3: Junction. Turn right to stay on the South Outlier Loop Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed South Outlier Loop Trail goes off ahead.)
1.1	0.7	J4: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Whitetail Refuge Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed South Outlier Loop Trail goes off on your left.)
1.8	1.1	Heads-up: The next 0.6 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
2.9	1.8	J5: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
3.0	1.9	J6: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the blue-blazed Springwater Side Trail goes off ahead.)
4.5	2.8	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).

4.8	3.0	J7: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Hockley Heights Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
5.0	3.1	J8: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
5.1	3.2	J7: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
5.4	3.4	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
6.9	4.3	J6: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Springwater Side Trail, heading south-west. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
7.2	4.5	J9: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
7.3	4.6	J10: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Turnbull Side Trail goes off on your left.)
7.7	4.8	J11: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Turnbull Side Trail goes off on your left.)
8.1	5.0	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Laidlaw Side Trail, heading west. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
8.4	5.2	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Oak Ridges Trail Association, Voyageur Tripper, OntarioCamping.ca, Wikipedia and the Town of Mono.